

Word family: **name / names / named / naming / nameless / namesake**

Base word: name

Part of speech: mainly **noun** and **verb**

Related forms:

* **name** (n.) — 名字；名稱；名聲；知名人物

* **name** (v.) — 命名；說出名字；指定；任命

* **named** (adj./participle) — 名叫.....的；被命名為.....的

* **naming** (n.) — 命名

* **nameless** (adj.) — 無名的；沒有名字的

* **namesake** (n.) — 同名的人 / 物

* **nameable** (adj., uncommon) — 可命名的

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **first name**

* **family name / surname**

* **full name**

* **middle name**

* **stage name**

* **brand name**

* **place name**

* **by name**

* **in someone's name**

* **make a name for yourself**

* **a big name**

* **clear someone's name**

* **give something a name**

* **name someone/something after someone**

* **name someone as... **

* **name a date / price**

* **name and shame**

* **namesake**

Meaning in this passage

> He never treated it as a dry subject full of **names** and dates.

Here, **names** means:

the names of people, especially historical figures — 人名

The speaker means that history was not taught merely as a list of historical people and dates to memorize.

****中文翻譯：****

他從不把歷史當成一門只有****人名****和年份的枯燥科目。

So here:

****names = 人物的名字；歷史人物姓名****

1. ****name (人的名字) — 名字；姓名****

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> He never treated history as a dry subject full of ****names**** and dates.

他從不把歷史當成一門只有****人名****和年份的枯燥科目。

Practice 2

> I can't remember his ****name****.

我記不起他的****名字****。

Practice 3

> Please write your ****name**** at the top of the page.

請在頁面上方寫上你的****姓名****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****name = 用來識別某個人的字詞或稱呼****

2. ****first name / given name — 名；名字****

Practice 1

> What's your ****first name****?

你的**名字**是甚麼？

Practice 2

> Please enter your **given name** and surname.

請填寫你的**名字和姓氏**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****first/given name = 個人名字中用來區分家庭成員的部分，通常不是姓氏****

3. **family name / surname — 姓氏**

Practice 1

> Chan is his **family name**.

Chan 是他的**姓氏**。

Practice 2

> Please write your **surname** in capital letters.

請用大楷填寫你的**姓氏**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****family name/surname = 表示家族身份、通常由家庭成員共享的姓名部分****

4. **full name — 全名**

Practice 1

> Please give me your **full name**.

請告訴我你的**全名**。

Practice 2

> His **full name** appears on the certificate.

證書上印有他的**完整姓名**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****full name = 包含主要姓名部分的完整名字****

5. ****name (事物 / 地方的名稱) — 名稱****

Not only people have names.

Practice 1

> What's the ****name**** of this street?

這條街的****名稱****是甚麼？

Practice 2

> The restaurant changed its ****name**** last year.

這間餐廳去年更改了****名稱****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****name = 用來識別地方、物件、組織、產品等的稱呼****

6. ****brand name — 品牌名稱****

Practice 1

> I don't remember the ****brand name****.

我記不起那個****品牌名稱****。

Practice 2

> The company changed its ****brand name****.

公司更改了****品牌名稱****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****brand name = 用來識別某個商業品牌的名稱****

7. ****place name — 地名****

Practice 1

> Many **place names** have interesting histories.

很多**地名**都有有趣的歷史。

Practice 2

> I always find this **place name** difficult to pronounce.

我一直覺得這個**地名**很難讀。

MCQ-ready definition:

place name = 用來識別城市、鄉村、街道、地區等地方的名稱

8. **stage name / pen name — 藝名 / 筆名**

Practice 1

> The singer performs under a **stage name**.

那名歌手以**藝名**演出。

Practice 2

> The author wrote under a **pen name**.

那名作者以**筆名**寫作。

MCQ-ready definition:

stage/pen name = 某人為表演或寫作而使用、不同於真名的名字

9. **name (名聲 ; 聲譽) — 名聲 ; 聲譽**

A major abstract sense.

Practice 1

> The company has a good **name** in the industry.

這間公司在業內有很好的**聲譽**。

Practice 2

> He worked hard to protect his family's **name**.

他努力維護家族的**名聲**。

MCQ-ready definition:

name = 某人、家庭或機構在別人心目中的聲譽和形象

10. **a good / bad name — 好 / 壞名聲**

Practice 1

> The school has a **good name**.

這間學校有很好的**名聲**。

Practice 2

> The scandal gave the company a **bad name**.

那宗醜聞令公司有了**壞名聲**。

MCQ-ready definition:

good/bad name = 好 / 壞的社會聲譽

11. **make a name for yourself — 闖出名堂；建立名聲**

Practice 1

> She **made a name for herself** as a designer.

她以設計師身份**闖出了名堂**。

Practice 2

> He hopes to **make a name for himself** in the industry.

他希望在業界**建立自己的名聲**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****make a name for yourself = 透過成就令自己變得知名並建立聲譽****

12. ****a big name — 大人物；知名人士 / 品牌****

Practice 1

> She is a ****big name**** in fashion.

她是時裝界的****知名人物****。

Practice 2

> Several ****big names**** attended the event.

幾位****名人 / 業界大人物****出席了活動。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****a big name = 在某個領域非常知名、有影響力的人或機構****

13. ****name (知名品牌 / 名牌) — 名牌；知名品牌****

Practice 1

> Consumers often pay more for a famous ****name****.

消費者往往願意為知名****品牌****多付錢。

Practice 2

> It's a respected ****name**** in the industry.

它是業內很受尊重的****知名品牌 / 名稱****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****name = 因知名度和聲譽而有價值的品牌或商業名稱****

14. ****by name — 按名字；知道某人的名字****

Practice 1

> The teacher knew every student ****by name****.

老師知道每位學生的****名字****。

Practice 2

> I know him ****by name****, but we've never met.

我****知道他的名字****，但我們從未見過。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****know/call someone by name = 知道或使用某人的名字來識別對方****

15. ****in someone's name — 以某人名義****

Practice 1

> The account is ****in her name****.

這個戶口是****以她的名義****開立的。

Practice 2

> The booking was made ****in my name****.

預訂是****以我的名字****登記的。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****in someone's name = 正式登記、擁有或進行某事時使用某人的姓名****

16. ****in the name of something — 以……之名；為了……****

Practice 1

> They claimed to act ****in the name of justice****.

他們聲稱自己是****以正義之名****行動。

Practice 2

> A lot has been done ****in the name of progress****.

很多事情都是**以進步之名**做的。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****in the name of X = 聲稱以 X 作為理由、原則或目的****

17. ****name someone/something (命名) — 給.....命名；稱作****

As a verb.

Practice 1

> They ****named the baby Leo****.

他們把嬰兒****取名為 Leo****。

Practice 2

> The new school was ****named after**** a local teacher.

新學校以一位本地老師的名字****命名****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****name someone/something = 給某人或某物一個正式或固定的名字****

18. ****name something after someone — 以某人名字命名****

Practice 1

> The street was ****named after**** a famous writer.

這條街以一位著名作家的名字****命名****。

Practice 2

> They ****named their son after**** his grandfather.

他們以祖父的名字為兒子****取名****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****name X after Y = 使用 Y 的名字來為 X 命名****

19. **name someone/something — 說出名字；指出是誰 / 甚麼**

Practice 1

> Can you **name all the countries** on the map?

你可以**說出地圖上所有國家的名稱**嗎？

Practice 2

> She couldn't **name the person** she had seen.

她無法**說出自己看見那人的名字**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****name someone/something = 說出或指出某人 / 某物的名字或身份****

20. **name a person as / name someone to a position — 指定；任命**

A major formal verb sense.

Practice 1

> She was **named captain** of the team.

她被**任命為隊長**。

Practice 2

> The company **named him as its new director**.

公司**任命他為新董事**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****name someone as X = 正式指定或宣布某人擔任某個角色或職位****

21. **name a winner / candidate — 指定 / 宣布人選**

Practice 1

> The judges will **name the winner** tomorrow.

評判明天會**公布 / 選出勝出者**。

Practice 2

> The party has not yet **named a candidate**.

該組織尚未**公布候選人**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****name someone = 正式選定、指定或公布某人身份****

22. **name a date / time — 定出日期 / 時間**

Practice 1

> They haven't **named a date** for the meeting.

他們還未**定下會議日期**。

Practice 2

> Just **name the time**, and I'll be there.

你只要**說個時間**，我就會到。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****name a date/time = 明確說出或決定某個日期 / 時間****

23. **name a price — 開價；說出價格**

Practice 1

> **Name your price**.

你**開個價吧**。

Practice 2

> He refused to **name a price**.

他拒絕**說出價格**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****name a price = 明確提出或說出所要求的價錢****

24. ****name names — 點名；公開說出名字****

Practice 1

> He refused to ****name names****.

他拒絕****點名****。

Practice 2

> The report described the problem without ****naming names****.

報告描述了問題，但沒有****公開指出相關人士的名字****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****name names = 明確公開指出涉及某件事的人的名字****

25. ****name and shame — 點名批評；公開曝光****

Practice 1

> The campaign plans to ****name and shame**** companies that break the rules.

該行動計劃****點名公開批評****違規公司。

Practice 2

> Some newspapers regularly ****name and shame**** offenders.

有些報章會定期****公開違規者的姓名加以批評****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****name and shame = 公開某人或機構的名字，藉此批評或令其感到羞恥****

26. ****clear someone's name — 洗脫嫌疑；恢復名譽****

Practice 1

> He fought to **clear his name**.

他努力**洗脫自己的嫌疑 / 恢復名譽**。

Practice 2

> New evidence finally **cleared her name**.

新證據終於替她**洗清嫌疑**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****clear someone's name = 證明某人沒有做被指控的壞事，恢復其聲譽****

27. **drag someone's name through the mud — 敗壞某人名聲**

Practice 1

> He accused them of **dragging his name through the mud**.

他指責他們**敗壞他的名聲**。

Practice 2

> The false story **dragged her name through the mud**.

那則假新聞**嚴重損害了她的名譽**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****drag someone's name through the mud = 公開說某人的壞話，令其聲譽受到嚴重損害****

28. **nameless — 無名的；不知名的**

Practice 1

> A **nameless** soldier was buried there.

一名**無名士兵**葬在那裏。

Practice 2

> He felt a **nameless fear**.

他感到一種**難以名狀的恐懼**。

MCQ-ready definition:

nameless = 沒有名字、不知姓名；也可指難以命名或形容的

29. **namesake — 同名的人 / 物**

Practice 1

> He was named after his grandfather and is his **namesake**.

他以祖父命名，兩人是**同名者**。

Practice 2

> The town and its **namesake river** share the same name.

這座城鎮和它的**同名河流**使用同一名稱。

MCQ-ready definition:

namesake = 與另一個人、地方或事物擁有相同名字的人或物

Important distinction 1: **name vs title**

name

identifies a person or thing.

title

can identify:

- * a book/film
- * a position
- * a form of address

> the name of the teacher

老師的名字

> the title of the book

書名

> job title

職銜

They overlap in some contexts but are not interchangeable.

Important distinction 2: **name** vs **word**

A **name** identifies a specific person/place/thing.

A **word** is any lexical item.

> “London” is a place name.

London 是地名。

> “city” is a word.

city 是一個單詞。

Important distinction 3: **name** vs **nickname**

name

general or official identity label.

nickname

informal alternative name.

> His name is Jonathan, but his nickname is Jon.

他的正式名字是 Jonathan，但暱稱是 Jon。

Important distinction 4: **name** vs **surname**

name

can refer to the whole name or any identifying name.

surname

specifically family name.

So:

> What's your name?

你的名字 / 姓名是甚麼？

is broader than:

> What's your surname?

你姓甚麼？

Important distinction 5: **name vs reputation**

name

can mean reputation in expressions like:

> a good name

reputation

is the ordinary explicit word for public opinion about someone.

So:

> protect your good name

維護好名聲

is more idiomatic/literary than simply:

> protect your reputation

Important distinction 6: ****a big name vs a famous name****

Both mean well-known, but:

****big name****

more idiomatic and often emphasizes influence/status.

****famous name****

focuses more directly on being well known.

Important distinction 7: ****name someone vs call someone****

****name someone****

give them an official/fixed name.

****call someone X****

refer to them using that name.

> They named him Leo.

他們替他取名 Leo。

> Everyone calls him Leo.

大家都叫他 Leo。

Important distinction 8: ****name after vs call after****

****name someone after someone****

standard:

= use another person's name.

> They named him after his grandfather.

他們以祖父的名字為他命名。

In British English, ****call someone after someone**** can occur, but ****name after**** is clearer and

more widely useful.

Important distinction 9: **name a date** vs **choose a date**

choose a date

select a date.

name a date

state/announce the chosen date explicitly.

So **name** emphasizes putting the exact label/date into words.

Important distinction 10: **name a price** vs **price something**

name a price

state the amount you want.

price something

set or determine its selling price.

Related, but not identical.

Important distinction 11: **named** = **called**

> a man **named Chan**

= a man **called Chan**

Both mean:

一位名叫 Chan 的男人

Named often sounds slightly more formal.

Important distinction 12: **name = identity vs name = reputation**

These are genuinely distinct learner senses.

Identity

> What's your name?

你叫甚麼名字？

Reputation

> The company has a good name.

這公司名聲很好。

The second cannot simply be translated as 「名字」.

Important distinction 13: **names in your passage are not “famous names”**

In:

> a dry subject full of **names and dates**

names simply means:

historical people's names to memorize

It does not mean:

* celebrities

* famous brands

* reputation

The plural is literal and concrete.

Family-extension note

Name has a rich modern structure built around the central idea:

a label that identifies someone or something

From there, English develops:

1. ****personal identity****

- * name
- * full name
- * surname

2. ****labels for things****

- * place name
- * brand name

3. ****reputation****

- * good name
- * make a name for yourself

4. ****fame/status****

- * a big name

5. ****verb: assign identity****

- * name a child
- * name something after someone

6. ****verb: identify explicitly****

- * name the countries
- * name names

7. ****verb: appoint/select****

- * name someone captain
- * name a candidate

8. ****verb: state exactly****

- * name a date
- * name a price

9. ****family extensions****

- * nameless
- * namesake

This is a strong polysemy family because ****identity → reputation → explicit identification → official selection**** creates several genuinely useful learner meanings.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
-----	-----	-----
name (person)	名字；姓名	personal identity
first name	名	personal given name
surname	姓氏	family identity
full name	全名	complete identity
name (thing/place)	名稱	identifying label
brand name	品牌名稱	commercial label
place name	地名	location label
stage name	藝名	alternative public name
name (reputation)	名聲；聲譽	public reputation
good name	好名聲	positive reputation
make a name for yourself	闖出名堂	become known
a big name	大人物；知名人士	famous influential person
by name	按名字；知道名字	personal identification
in someone's name	以某人名義	formal registration
in the name of X	以 X 之名	claimed principle
name someone	給某人命名	assign name
name X after Y	以 Y 命名 X	use another name
name X	說出 X 的名稱	identify explicitly
name someone as X	任命 / 指定為 X	appoint
name a winner	公布 / 選出勝出者	identify officially
name a date	定出日期	state exact date
name a price	開價	state amount
name names	點名	publicly identify
name and shame	點名批評	expose publicly
clear someone's name	洗脫嫌疑	restore reputation
nameless	無名的	without name
namesake	同名的人 / 物	same name

For your original sentence

> He never treated it as a dry subject full of ****names and dates****.

Here:

names = 人名；歷史人物的姓名

The phrase deliberately represents the stereotypical way of teaching history as pure memorization:

> **names + dates = 人名 + 年份**

Mr Chan did the opposite—he turned those facts into human stories.

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 他從不把歷史當成一門只有**人名和年份**的枯燥科目。

So the exact passage sense is the straightforward **personal-name** meaning of **name**.